

HOUSE BILL 2282

By Carringer

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 8,
Chapter 50, relative to leave for public employees.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 8, Chapter 50, Part 8, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

8-50-815.

(a) Special leave is granted to an eligible employee who is a foster parent or kinship caregiver. The eligible employee may use this leave for when the employee is required to appear in court or counseling sessions regarding the placement of a foster child.

(b) Leave used by an eligible employee pursuant to this section must not be charged to sick, annual, or other leave the employee may have accumulated.

(c) Leave granted pursuant to this section must count toward the eligible employee's use of leave required to be given by this state as an employer under the federal Family and Medical Leave Act (29 U.S.C. § 2601, et seq.) and § 4-21-408.

(d) An eligible employee must not be granted more than five (5) workdays of paid leave under subsection (a) during a twelve-month period.

(e) As used in this section, "eligible employee" means:

(1) An employee who has been employed full-time with the state for at least twelve (12) consecutive months with an entity described in §§ 8-30-102(a), 8-30-102(b)(2), 8-30-102(b)(6)-(7), and 8-30-102(b)(10)-(13); or

(2) An employee who has been employed full-time with the state for at least twelve (12) consecutive months with an entity described in § 8-30-

102(b)(9), except for an employee of any administrative board or commission

that is attached to an entity described in § 8-30-102(b)(1) or § 8-30-102(b)(3)-(5).

SECTION 2. This act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it.